

Activity 4 – Unlocking the Impossible

Assessment Stress-Test with AI

Purpose

For many educators, **AI-robust assessment that still feels authentic** currently feels impossible. This activity uses a simple **3-step workflow** to stress-test an assessment task with AI, critique what happens, and sketch small redesigns that make **student thinking and judgement more visible**.

This aligns with the spirit of **Assessment 2030**: assessments where human skills remain irreplaceable, even when AI is available.

Core Activity (Teaching / Pedagogy)

3-step workflow:

- 1) Ask AI to complete the task
- 2) Critique the AI response
- 3) Ask AI for redesign ideas – then apply your judgement

Step 1 – Choose an assessment task

Work individually or in small groups.

Choose ONE of the following:

- An assessment task from your own unit (preferred)
- A sample assignment task provided in the workshop

Paste or summarise the task here:

Task:

If you have AI access and time, you (or the facilitator) can stress-test it live.

Example completion prompt:

You are a high-achieving student in a [year, discipline] unit at an Australian university.
Here is an assessment task description:
[paste task]

Produce a **strong response** to this task.
Assume you have access only to typical online information and your own reasoning.
After your response, briefly explain what strategies you used to complete the task.

If live AI isn't available, imagine what a strong AI-generated answer would look like, based on your task.

Step 2 – Critique the AI's response

Using the AI response (or your imagined one), ask:

Purpose & Stakes

- What is this assessment really trying to measure?
- Is it high-stakes or low-stakes for students?

Plausibility & Evidence

- Does the AI answer *look* like a plausible pass or HD?
- Does it show genuine understanding, or mainly fluent generic text?
- Does it use appropriate evidence/examples (or would they need checking)?

Human Visibility

- Where can you see **student thinking, judgement, or personal context** in this response (if at all)?
- Which parts could almost any AI produce, given your brief?

Jot a few notes:

What worries you most about this response?

Step 3 – Explore redesign ideas and choose 1–2 tweaks

Now shift from “problem” to “design opportunity”.

If you wish, you can ask AI for redesign suggestions, then apply your judgement.

Example redesign prompt:

You are an educational designer working within an AI-aware assessment policy similar to **Assessment 2030**.

Given this original assessment task:

[paste task]

Suggest **3 specific changes** that would:

- Make student thinking and judgement more visible
- Allow **transparent, limited use of AI** as a tool
- Still be realistic for a typical class size in [discipline].

Present your answer as bullet points: each bullet = “Change” + “What it achieves”.

Whether or not you use AI for this step, brainstorm **2–3 small tweaks** you might make to this task. For example:

- Add a short **in-class component** (oral defence, live explanation, whiteboard sketch)
- Require a brief **AI use log** (what was used, why, and what was changed)
- Ask students to apply ideas to a **personal or local context** AI is unlikely to know
- Emphasise **process documentation** (drafts, annotations) rather than only final product

List 1–2 tweaks you would seriously consider:

Possible tweaks:

- 1.
- 2.

Variants for Researchers and Professional Staff

You can apply the same 3-step workflow to other “impossible” or high-stakes tasks.

If you are mainly doing research

Try stress-testing a research-adjacent task, such as:

- A **grant impact statement**
- A **data collection plan**
- A **lay summary** for a project

Workflow:

1. Ask AI to draft the section (impact, plan, or summary).

2. Critique: Is it plausible? Generic? Feasible? Ethically sound? Missing key theories or methods?
3. Ask AI for **2–3 improvements**, then decide which (if any) you would keep.

If you are in a professional / administrative role

Try a parallel stress-test on a **process communication**, for example:

- Instructions for special consideration, extensions, course transfers
- Information about fees, scholarships, or academic progress

Workflow:

1. Paste a real process description and ask AI to produce a **student-facing explanation**.
 2. Critique: Where is it misleading, incomplete, or tone-deaf? Does it match reality?
 3. Ask AI for improvements, then apply your **policy knowledge and judgement** before using anything.
-

Reflection / Notes

Use the prompts below and the space provided.

- What did you learn about how easily AI could complete your task?
- Where is student thinking/judgement currently **visible** – and where is it not?
- What is one realistic change you could make to move this task closer to **AI-aware, authentic assessment** in your context?

(Notes:)

-
-
-
-